

THE CASE FOR CHOOSING JETPACK OVER XUL

When you have to pick sides, make sure you pick the right one

Now that you know of the ways by which you can develop for Firefox, it's probably time for you to play favorites. And we should probably pronounce our verdict about the better option. Without further ado, we think it's Jetpack.

XUL and Jetpack aren't exactly in direct competition here. XUL, as we know, is not a standalone way to develop for Firefox – it simply defines the UI, for which you then proceed to fill up the JavaScript. XUL is to a browser what HTML is to a webpage.

As we've already said, the average Jetpack add-on is not really in direct competition with the XUL / JS pairing. Look at it this way: XUL tells you what you can't do, giving you the ability to do anything other than what was explicitly denied. Jetpack, on the other hand, tells you what you can do, and you can't do anything else. That, of course, extends from the fact